

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12389661
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 12, 2025
Inventor(s)	Lee; Li-Chen et al.

Method for modifying metal-including material in semiconductor manufacturing process

Abstract

A method for manufacturing a semiconductor device includes forming a metal-including layer over a semiconductor substrate; forming a hydrophobic polymer layer over the metal-including layer; and forming an amphiphilic polymer layer between the metal-including layer and the hydrophobic polymer layer so as to enhance a bonding force therebetween.

Inventors: Lee; Li-Chen (Hsinchu, TW), Chen; Ren-Kai (Hsinchu, TW), Chuang; Ying-Liang (Hsinchu, TW), Yeh; Ming-Hsi (Hsinchu, TW), Huang; Kuo-Bin (Hsinchu, TW)

Applicant: TAIWAN SEMICONDUCTOR MANUFACTURING COMPANY, LTD.
(Hsinchu, TW)

Family ID: 88512623

Assignee: TAIWAN SEMICONDUCTOR MANUFACTURING COMPANY, LTD.
(Hsinchu, TW)

Appl. No.: 17/731057

Filed: April 27, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230352346 A1	Nov. 02, 2023

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H10D84/03 (20250101); C23C16/40 (20060101); H10D30/01 (20250101); H10D30/67 (20250101); H10D64/01 (20250101); H10D84/01 (20250101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **H10D84/038** (20250101); **C23C16/403** (20130101); **H10D64/01** (20250101);
H10D84/017 (20250101); **H10D84/0186** (20250101); H10D30/031 (20250101);
H10D30/6735 (20250101)

Field of Classification Search

USPC: None

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
6054255	12/1999	Nakaoka	427/407.1	G03F 7/16
10276452	12/2018	Seshadri	N/A	H10D 88/01
2004/0152329	12/2003	Di Dio	257/E21.027	H01L 21/0274
2005/0175786	12/2004	Singh	427/407.1	A61M 35/006
2007/0030309	12/2006	McAvoy	347/54	B41J 2/1646
2009/0036625	12/2008	Chang	526/272	C08F 222/04
2012/0313170	12/2011	Chang	257/E21.409	H10D 62/292
2022/0328427	12/2021	Coppola	N/A	H01L 23/564

Primary Examiner: Page; Dale E

Assistant Examiner: Cullen; Patrick

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Birch, Stewart, Kolasch & Birch, LLP

Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) Along with increasing demands on more advanced semiconductor devices, manufacturing processes thereof also encounter a lot of challenges. To overcome such challenges, the industry has put much effort in developing different techniques applicable to methods for manufacturing semiconductor devices.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Aspects of the present disclosure are best understood from the following detailed description when read with the accompanying figures. It is noted that, in accordance with the standard practice in the industry, various features are not drawn to scale. In fact, the dimensions of the various features may be arbitrarily increased or reduced for clarity of discussion.

(2) FIG. 1 is a flow diagram illustrating a method for manufacturing a semiconductor device in accordance with some embodiments.

(3) FIGS. 2 to 16, 18 and 19 are schematic views illustrating intermediate stages of the method for

manufacturing a semiconductor device in accordance with some embodiments.

(4) FIG. 17 is a diagram illustrating bottom film loss with and without amphiphilic polymer layer in accordance with some embodiments.

(5) FIG. 20 is a schematic view illustrating an intermediate stage of the method for manufacturing another semiconductor device in accordance with some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(6) The following disclosure provides many different embodiments, or examples, for implementing different features of the disclosure. Specific examples of components and arrangements are described below to simplify the present disclosure. These are, of course, merely examples and are not intended to be limiting. For example, the formation of a first feature over or on a second feature in the description that follows may include embodiments in which the first and second features are formed in direct contact, and may also include embodiments in which additional features may be formed between the first and second features, such that the first and second features may not be in direct contact. In addition, the present disclosure may repeat reference numerals and/or letters in the various examples. This repetition is for the purpose of simplicity and clarity and does not in itself dictate a relationship between the various embodiments and/or configurations discussed.

(7) Further, spatially relative terms, such as “on,” “above,” “top,” “bottom,” “upper,” “lower,” “over,” “beneath,” and the like, may be used herein for ease of description to describe one element or feature's relationship to another element(s) or feature(s) as illustrated in the figures. The spatially relative terms are intended to encompass different orientations of the device in use or operation in addition to the orientation depicted in the figures. The apparatus may be otherwise oriented (rotated 90 degrees or at other orientations) and the spatially relative descriptors used herein may likewise be interpreted accordingly.

(8) The present disclosure is directed to a method for manufacturing a semiconductor device, in which a surface of a metal-including layer is modified by forming an amphiphilic polymer layer between the metal-including layer and a hydrophobic polymer layer (e.g., bottom anti-reflective coating (BARC)) so as to enhance a bonding force therebetween. The present disclosure provides an exemplary method to manufacture, for example, but not limited to, a metal-oxide-semiconductor field effect transistor (MOSFET), such as a planar MOSFET, a fin-type FET (FinFET), a gate-all-around (GAA) nanosheet FET, or other suitable semiconductor devices.

(9) FIG. 1 is a flow diagram illustrating a method for manufacturing the semiconductor device in accordance with some embodiments. FIGS. 2 to 16, 18 and 19 illustrate schematic views of the intermediate stages of the method in accordance with some embodiments. Some repeating structures are omitted in FIGS. 2 to 16, 18 and 19 for the sake of brevity. Additional steps can be provided before, after or during the method, and some of the steps described herein may be replaced by other steps or be eliminated.

(10) Referring to FIG. 1 and the example illustrated in FIG. 2, the method begins at step 201, where a semiconductor structure is formed. FIG. 2 is an enlarged top view of the semiconductor structure in accordance with some embodiments. The semiconductor structure includes a semiconductor substrate 50 (see FIG. 5), a plurality of semiconductor fins 52, a dummy portion 53, a plurality of isolation portions 58, a plurality of fin sidewalls 520, and two gate spacers 54.

(11) The semiconductor substrate 50 may be made of elemental semiconductor materials, such as crystalline silicon, diamond, or germanium; compound semiconductor materials, such as silicon carbide, gallium arsenic, indium arsenide, or indium phosphide; or alloy semiconductor materials, such as silicon germanium, silicon germanium carbide, gallium arsenic phosphide, or gallium indium phosphide. The material for forming the semiconductor substrate 50 may be doped with p-type impurities or n-type impurities, or undoped. In addition, the semiconductor substrate 50 may be a bulk silicon substrate, a silicon-on-insulator (SOI) substrate, or a germanium-on-insulator (GOI) substrate. Other suitable materials for the semiconductor substrate 50 are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(12) The semiconductor fins **52** are formed on the semiconductor substrate **50**, and may be made from a material the same or different from that of the semiconductor substrate **50**. Since suitable materials for the semiconductor fins **52** are similar to those for the semiconductor substrate **50**, the details thereof are omitted for the sake of brevity. Other suitable materials for the semiconductor fins **52** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure. In some embodiments, the semiconductor fins **52** extend in an X direction, and are spaced apart from each other in a Y direction transverse to the X direction. Although two of the semiconductor fins **52** are shown in FIG. 2, the number of the semiconductor fins **52** can be varied according to the layout design of the semiconductor structure.

(13) The isolation portions **58** are formed on the semiconductor substrate **50** to isolate the semiconductor fins **52** from each other. The isolation portions **58** may each be a portion of a shallow trench isolation (STI), a deep trench isolation (DTI), or other suitable structures, and may be made of an oxide material (for example, silicon oxide), a nitride material (for example, silicon nitride), or a combination thereof. Other suitable materials for the isolation portions **58** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(14) The dummy portion **53** extends in the Y direction, and is formed over the semiconductor fins **52**. In some embodiments, the dummy portion **53** includes a hard mask **530**, a dummy gate **531** (see FIG. 4) formed beneath the hard mask **530**, and a dummy gate dielectric (not shown) formed beneath the dummy gate **531** to separate the dummy gate **531** from the semiconductor fins **52**. In some embodiments, the hard mask **530** may include silicon nitride, silicon oxide, silicon oxynitride, or combinations thereof; the dummy gate **531** may include polycrystalline silicon, single crystalline silicon, amorphous silicon, or combinations thereof; and the dummy dielectric may include silicon oxide, silicon nitride, silicon oxynitride, high dielectric constant (k) materials, or combinations thereof. Other suitable materials for the dummy portion **53** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(15) The gate spacers **54** are formed at two opposite sides of the dummy portion **53**, and each of the semiconductor fins **52** has two recessed fin portions **521** exposed from the dummy structure **53** and the gate spacers **54**. At two opposite sides of each of the recessed fin portions **521**, two corresponding ones of the fin sidewalls **520** are formed. Each of the gate spacers **54** and the fin sidewalls **520** may include silicon oxide, silicon nitride, or a combination thereof. Other suitable materials for the gate spacers **54** and the fin sidewalls **520** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(16) In some embodiments, the semiconductor structure may be formed by (i) patterning the semiconductor substrate **50** to form the semiconductor fins **52**, (ii) forming an isolation layer over the semiconductor substrate **50** and the semiconductor fins **52** followed by a planarization process, for example, but not limited to, chemical mechanism polishing (CMP), to form the isolation portions **58**, (iii) recessing the isolation portions **58** to expose upper portions of the semiconductor fins **52**, (iv) forming the dummy portion **53** over the semiconductor fins **52** such that each of the semiconductor fins **52** has two fin portions exposed from and located at two opposite sides of the dummy portion **53**, (v) forming, the two gate spacers **54** at two opposite sides of the dummy portion **53**, and the two fin sidewalls **520** at two opposite sides of each of the fin portions of the semiconductor fins **52**, and (vi) recessing the fin portions of each of the semiconductor fins **52** to form the recessed fin portions **521**. Other suitable processes for forming the semiconductor structure **100** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(17) Referring to FIG. 1 and the example illustrated in FIG. 3, the method proceeds to step **202**, where a plurality of source/drain portions **13** are respectively formed in the recessed fin portions **521**. In some embodiments, two or more adjacent ones of the source/drain portions **13** may be merged to form a merged portion **13A** according to designs. For instance, as shown in FIG. 5, two of the source/drain portions **13** are merged to form a diamond-like shape structure, and two merged portions **13A** shown in FIG. 3 are formed at two opposite sides of the dummy portion **53**. Please

note that each of the merged portions **13A** (including a plurality of the source/drain portions **13**) may also be referred to as a source/drain portion.

(18) In some embodiments, each of the source/drain portions **13** may include multiple epitaxial layers, each may include silicon, silicon germanium, silicon carbide, germanium, III-V compound semiconductors, or combinations thereof. Other suitable materials for the epitaxial layers are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure. For an n-FET device, each of the epitaxial layers may be doped with an n-type impurity, for example, but not limited to, phosphorus. For a p-FET device, each of the epitaxial layers may be doped with a p-type impurity, for example, but not limited to, boron. The semiconductor epitaxial layer may include silicon, silicon germanium, silicon carbide, germanium, III-V compound semiconductors, or combinations thereof. Other suitable materials for the p-type impurity and/or the n-type impurity are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(19) Referring to FIG. **1** and the example illustrated in FIG. **4**, the method proceeds to step **203**, where a contact etch stop layer (CESL) **150** and a dielectric layer **151** are sequentially formed over the structure shown in FIG. **3**. In some embodiments, the dielectric layer **151** is known as the interlayer dielectric (ILD) layer. FIG. **5** is a cross sectional view taken along line A-A of the structure shown in FIG. **4**. In FIG. **5**, some elements, such as the CESL **150**, the fin side walls **520**, and so on, are not shown for the sake of clarity. In some embodiments, step **203** is performed by sequentially depositing the CESL **150** and the dielectric layer **151** using a blanket deposition process, such as, but not limited to, chemical vapor deposition (CVD), high density plasma CVD (HDPCVD), sub-atmospheric CVD (SACVD), or molecular layer deposition (MLD), followed by a planarization process, for example, but not limited to, CMP, thereby exposing the dummy gate **531**. In other words, the hard mask **530** shown in FIG. **3** is removed after step **203**. Other suitable processes for forming the CESL **150** and the dielectric layer **151** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(20) In some embodiments, the CESL **150** includes, for example, but not limited to, silicon nitride, carbon-doped silicon nitride, other suitable materials, or combinations thereof. The dielectric layer **151** includes a dielectric material such as, but not limited to, silicon oxide, silicon nitride, silicon oxynitride, other suitable materials, or combinations thereof. Other suitable materials for forming the CESL **150** and the dielectric layer **151** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(21) Referring to FIG. **1** and the example illustrated in FIG. **6**, the method proceeds to step **204**, where a replacement gate (RPG) process is performed to replace the remaining of the dummy portion **53** (i.e., the dummy gate **531** and the dummy dielectric) with a gate portion **55** which includes a gate electrode **551** and a gate dielectric **552**. In some embodiments, step **204** includes (i) removing the dummy gate **531** and the dummy dielectric to form a trench (not shown) using dry etching, wet etching, other suitable processes, or combinations thereof, (ii) sequentially depositing layers of the gate dielectric **552** and the gate electrode **551** to fill the trench by a blanket deposition process, such as CVD, HDPCVD, SACVD, MLD, or physical vapor deposition (PVD), and (iii) performing a planarization process, for example, but not limited to, CMP, to remove excesses of the gate electrode **551** and the gate dielectric **552** and to expose the dielectric layer **151**. Other suitable processes for forming the gate portion **55** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(22) In some embodiments, the gate dielectric **552** includes silicon oxide, silicon nitride, silicon oxynitride, high dielectric constant (k) materials, other suitable materials, or combinations thereof, and the gate electrode **551** includes aluminum, tungsten, copper, other suitable materials, or combinations thereof. Other suitable materials for forming the gate portion **55** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(23) Referring to FIG. **1** and the example illustrated in FIG. **7**, the method proceeds to step **205**, where a plurality of trenches **152** (one of which is shown) are formed in the dielectric layer **151**.

FIG. 7 is a view similar to that of FIG. 5, but illustrating the structure after completing step 205. For better understanding, FIGS. 8 to 12, 14, 16, 18 and 19 illustrate structures subsequent to the structure shown in FIG. 7 (i.e., after step 205).

(24) Each of the trenches 152 extends through the dielectric layer 151 and the CESL 150 to expose a corresponding one of the source/drain portions 13A. In some embodiments, step 205 includes (i) forming a patterned mask layer (not shown) to cover a top surface of the structure shown in FIG. 6, the patterned mask layer being a patterned photoresist or a patterned hard mask and having openings in positions respectively corresponding to the source/drain portions 13A, (ii) etching the dielectric layer 151 and the CESL 150 through the openings of the patterned mask layer using dry etching, wet etching, other suitable processes, or combinations thereof, to form the trenches 152 until the source/drain portions 13A are exposed from the trenches 152, and (iii) removing the patterned mask layer. Other suitable processes for forming the trenches 152 are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(25) Referring to FIG. 1 and the example illustrated in FIG. 8, the method proceeds to step 206, where a silicide layer 220 is formed over the dielectric layer 151 and in the trenches 152 covering a trench sidewall and a trench bottom of each of the trenches 152. The silicide layer 220 may include silicon and at least one metallic element, for example, but not limited to, titanium (Ti), nickel (Ni), other suitable materials, or combinations thereof. Other suitable materials for forming the silicide layer 220 are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure. The silicide layer 220 may be formed by any suitable processes. In some embodiments, the silicide layer 220 formed on the trench bottom may have a thickness larger than that of the silicide layer 220 formed on the trench sidewall. This is to facilitate step 213 to be performed subsequently, and will be discussed hereinafter.

(26) Referring to FIG. 1 and the example illustrated in FIG. 9, the method proceeds to step 207, where a first metallic layer 110, which is a metal-including layer, is formed over the semiconductor substrate 50 in the trenches 152 and covers the silicide layer 220. The first metallic layer 110 includes at least one of tungsten, tungsten nitride, aluminum oxide, titanium nitride, aluminum, tantalum nitride, cobalt, titanium, tantalum, nickel, molybdenum, copper, and the like. Other suitable materials for forming the first metallic layer 110 are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure. The first metallic layer 110 may be formed by, for instance, PVD. Other suitable processes for forming the first metallic layer 110 are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure. It is noted that the first metallic layer 110 has a hydrophilic surface, which in some cases, includes an oxide or hydroxide of the metal present therein. In some embodiments, the first metallic layer 110 formed on the trench bottom may have a thickness larger than that of the first metallic layer formed on the trench sidewall. This is to facilitate step 213 to be performed subsequently, and will be discussed hereinafter.

(27) Referring to FIG. 1 and the example illustrated in FIG. 10, the method proceeds to step 208, where the first metallic layer 110 is subjected to a modification process. In some embodiments, the modification process is performed by forming an amphiphilic polymer layer 130 over the first metallic layer 110. Step 208 may include the following substeps: (i) forming a solution including an amphiphilic polymer material; (ii) applying the solution over the first metallic layer 110; and (iii) performing a drying process so as to obtain the amphiphilic polymer layer 130 including the amphiphilic polymer material. In substep (i), the solution may be formed by dissolving the amphiphilic polymer material in a suitable organic solvent (determined according to practical needs). In substep (ii), in some embodiments, the solution may be applied by, for instance, evenly spraying over the first metallic layer 110 at a suitable temperature, for instance but not limited to, room temperature (about 25° C. to about 40° C.). In substep (iii), the drying process may include, but not limited to, air drying, thereby forming the amphiphilic polymer layer 130. The formation of the amphiphilic polymer layer 130 generally does not require any heating (may be adjusted according to practical needs), and makes it easy to modify the first metallic layer 110. Other

suitable processes for forming the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(28) In some embodiments, the amphiphilic polymer material for forming the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** includes a polymer backbone **1301**, hydrophobic groups **1302** attached to the polymer backbone **1301**, and hydrophilic groups **1303** attached to the polymer backbone **1301** (see FIG. **13**). A number of the hydrophobic groups **1302** is greater than that of the hydrophilic groups **1303**. The amphiphilic polymer layer **130** may be present as a self-assembled monolayer (SAM).

(29) In some embodiments, the hydrophobic groups **1302** each independently is a saturated alkyl, a phenyl, or the likes. For hydrophobic groups **1302** that are saturated alkyl, a number of carbon atom may range from one to three. That is, each of the hydrophobic groups **1302** may be a short saturated alkyl chain. Such short alkyl chain may avoid undesired aggregation of the alkyl chain as occurred in long alkyl chain. In addition, the saturated alkyl is relatively unreactive compared to unsaturated hydrocarbons such as alkenyl or alkynyl, which is conducive to avoiding reactions with any other species. Example of the phenyl may include, but not limited to, benzene, which is also considered as an unreactive species. Other suitable materials for forming the hydrophobic groups **1302** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure. The hydrophobic groups **1302** may be bonded to other species by van Der Waals force. In some embodiments, the hydrophobic groups **1302** are evenly distributed along the polymer backbone **1301**.

(30) In some embodiments, the hydrophilic groups **1303** each independently is hydroxyl, carboxyl, amide or amino. Other suitable materials for forming the hydrophilic groups **1303** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure. The hydrophilic groups **1303** may be bonded to other species by hydrogen bond.

(31) Referring to FIG. **1** and the example illustrated in FIG. **11**, the method proceeds to step **209**, where a hydrophobic polymer layer **120** is formed over the amphiphilic polymer layer **130**.

(32) In some embodiments, the hydrophobic polymer layer **120** includes a bottom anti-reflective coating (BARC) material. BARC is a porous polymer prepared from, for example, but not limited to, styrene monomers and epoxy cross-linkers, and is relatively hydrophobic compared to the first metallic layer **110**. Other suitable materials for forming the hydrophobic polymer layer **120** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(33) Referring to FIG. **1** and the example illustrated in FIG. **12**, the method proceeds to step **210**, where an upper portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer **120** is removed, and a remaining lower portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer **120** is denoted by the numeral **120'**. The hydrophobic polymer layer **120'** covers a second portion **112** of the first metallic layer **110**, leaving a first portion **111** of the first metallic layer **110** being exposed from the hydrophobic polymer layer **120**. In addition, the silicide layer **220** has a first portion **221** located beneath the first portion **111** of the first metallic layer **110**, and a second portion **222** located beneath the second portion **112** of the first metallic layer **110**. The upper portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer **120** may be removed by, for instance, an etching process using any suitable etchants which have a high etch selectivity for the hydrophobic polymer layer **120** relative to the first metallic layer **110**. Other suitable processes for removing the hydrophobic polymer layer **120** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(34) FIG. **13** is a schematic diagram demonstrating the role of the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** formed between the hydrophobic polymer layer **120'** and the first metallic layer **110**. A surface of the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** that confronts the first metallic layer **110** is hydrophilic, and the hydrophilic groups **1303** of the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** may form hydrogen bond with the metal oxide and/or metal hydroxide, or the likes located on the hydrophilic surface of first metallic layer **110**, leaving the hydrophobic groups **1302** of the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** opposite to the first metallic layer **110**. As such, the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** permits a hydrophobic surface to be formed over the first metallic layer **110**. In addition, a surface of the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** that confronts the hydrophobic polymer layer **120'** is hydrophobic,

and the hydrophobic groups **1302** of the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** may be bonded to the styrene molecules by van der Waal force in the case of the hydrophobic polymer layer **120'** being made of BARC. As such, the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** is capable of simultaneously bonding to both the hydrophobic polymer layer **120'** and the first metallic layer **110**, thus enhancing a bonding force between the first metallic layer **110** and the hydrophobic polymer layer **120'**.

(35) Referring to FIG. **1** and the examples illustrated in FIGS. **12** and **14**, the method proceeds to step **211**, where the first portion **111** of the first metallic layer **110** and the first portion **221** of the silicide layer **220** are removed, leaving the second portion **112** of the first metallic layer **110** and the second portion **222** of the silicide layer **220**. The second portion **112** of the first metallic layer **110** has a sidewall region **112B** located on the trench sidewall, and a bottom region **112A** located on the trench bottom. The second portion **222** of the silicide layer **220** has a sidewall region **222B** located on the trench sidewall, and a bottom region **222A** located on the trench bottom.

(36) In some embodiments, the removal of the first portions **111**, **221** of the first metallic layer **110** and the silicide layer **220** is performed by wet etching using any suitable wet etchant which has a high etching selectivity for the first metallic layer **110** and the silicide layer **220** relative to the other elements, such as the dielectric layer **151**. Step **211** also aims to retain the second portion **112** of the first metallic layer **110**, however, considering the hydrophobic polymer layer **120'** being a porous layer, the wet etchant may pass through the hydrophobic polymer layer **120'** and reach the second portion **112** of the first metallic layer **110**. In the case of omitting the amphiphilic polymer layer **130**, the wet etchant may unintentionally etch away the second portions **112**, **222** of the first metallic layer **110** and the silicide layer **220**. Referring to FIG. **15**, by including the amphiphilic polymer layer **130**, the wet etchant (denoted by the numeral **90**) will first reach the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** after passing through the hydrophobic polymer layer **120'**. Since the surface of the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** that confronts the hydrophobic polymer layer **120'** is hydrophobic, the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** may serve as a waterproof layer to hinder, or slow down, the wet etchants **90** from reaching and undesirably damaging the second portion **112** of the first metallic layer **110**. That is, the first metallic layer **110** covered by the amphiphilic polymer layer **130**, i.e., the modified first metallic layer **110**, exhibits improved chemical resistance to wet etchants. For instance, in a peeling test to evaluate a resisting time period for the first metallic layer **110** to be observed with bubble defect when a wet etchant (for example, an etchant for a standard clean or a RCA clean) is applied thereon (indicating that the wet etchant penetrates through the hydrophobic polymer layer **120'** and damages the first metallic layer **110**), a sample that includes the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** between the first metallic layer **110** and the hydrophobic polymer layer **120'** may have a resisting time period much longer than a sample without the amphiphilic polymer layer **130**. For example, but not limited to, the resisting time period of the sample with the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** may be approximately 1.5 times to 2.5 times of that of the sample without the amphiphilic polymer layer **130**.

(37) Referring to FIG. **1** and the example illustrated in FIG. **16**, the method proceeds to step **212**, where the hydrophobic polymer layer **120'** is removed by, for example but not limited to, an ashing process. Other suitable processes for removing the hydrophobic polymer layer **120'** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(38) Considering that step **211** aims to remove the first portion **111**, and to retain the second portion **112** of the first metallic layer **110**, an experiment is performed to evaluate film loss of the first metallic layer **110**. FIG. **17** is a graph showing film loss of the bottom region **112A** of the first metallic layer **110** with and without inclusion of the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. Film loss refers to a thickness of the bottom region **112A** of the first metallic layer **110** that is etched away by the wet etchant used in step **211**. The results show that the film loss of the bottom region **112A** after step **211** may be effectively reduced with the presence of the amphiphilic polymer layer **130**. This suggests that the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** may avoid or slow down penetration of the wet etchant to the second portion

112 of the first metallic layer **110**, and is beneficial to permit the bottom region **112A** of the first metallic layer **110** to remain intact, so as to facilitate subsequent steps.

(39) Referring to FIG. **1** and the examples illustrated in FIGS. **16** and **18**, the method proceeds to step **213**, where the second portions **112**, **222** of the first metallic layer **110** and the silicide layer **220** are partially removed such that the sidewall region **112B** of the first metallic layer **110** and the sidewall region **222B** of the silicide layer **220** are removed while the bottom region **112A** of the first metallic layer **110** and the bottom region **222A** of the silicide layer **220** remain.

(40) In some embodiments, step **213** may be performed by any suitable etching process, such as an isotropic etching process which has substantially same etching selectivity and etching rate over each of the first metallic layer **110** and the silicide layer **220** formed on the trench bottom, i.e., the bottom regions **112A**, **222A**, and on the trench sidewall, i.e., the sidewall regions **112B**, **222B**. In such case, by forming the bottom regions **112A**, **222A** thicker than the sidewall regions **112B**, **222B**, the sidewall regions **112B**, **222B** may be completely removed in step **213**, while a sufficient thickness of each of the bottom regions **112A**, **222A** may be retained, so as to facilitate step **214** to be performed subsequently. Any other suitable processes for removing the sidewall region **112B** of the first metallic layer **110** and the sidewall region **222B** of the silicide layer **220** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(41) Referring to FIG. **1** and the example illustrated in FIG. **19**, the method proceeds to step **214**, where a second metallic layer **119** is formed on the remaining bottom region **112A** of the first metallic layer **110**.

(42) Step **214** may include sub-steps of: (i) filling a second metallic material in the trench **152** by, for example, but not limited to, a CVD process, or any other suitable processes, and (ii) planarizing (by e.g., CMP) the second metal-including material to remove an excess thereof, thereby obtaining the second metallic layer **119**. The second metallic material is used to form the second metallic layer **119**, and may include, for example, tungsten. Other suitable materials and processing for forming the second metallic layer **119** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(43) It is noted that in some embodiments, in sub-step (i), the second metallic material (made of, e.g., tungsten) growing on merely the bottom region **112A** of the first metallic layer **110** (made of, e.g., another form of tungsten) has improved growth performance than directly growing on both the sidewall region **112B** and the bottom region **112A**, and is beneficial for obtaining a semiconductor device with improved electrical properties.

(44) In some embodiments, the second metallic layer **119** may serve as a “metal-to-device (MD) contact”, i.e., contact to conductive region of the semiconductor device such as the source/drain portions.

(45) It should be noted that some steps in the method may be modified, replaced, or eliminated without departure from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure, and those steps may not be in the order mentioned above. In alternative embodiments, other suitable methods may also be applied for forming the semiconductor device.

(46) For example, step **208**, which involves modifying the first metallic layer (i.e., metal-including layer **110**) by forming an amphiphilic polymer layer **130** thereon, as mentioned in the exemplary embodiment above, permits the metal-including layer **110** to have improved adhesion with the hydrophobic polymer layer **120** including, e.g., BARC, and may also be applied in any other suitable manufacturing methods of semiconductor devices involving application of the hydrophobic polymer layer **120**, e.g., but not limited to, BARC, over the metal-including layer **110**. FIG. **20** is a schematic diagram illustrating an intermediate step of another exemplary embodiment of a method for manufacturing another semiconductor device, e.g., a GAA nanosheet FET, in which a step of patterning a portion of a metal-including layer **410** is shown, and which involves the formation of the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** between the metal-including layer **410** and the hydrophobic polymer layer **120**.

(47) As shown in FIG. **20**, a first nanounit **310** is formed on a first region **50A** of a semiconductor

substrate **50**, and a second nanounit **320** is formed on a second region **50B** of the semiconductor substrate **50**. The metal-including layer **410** is formed over the semiconductor substrate **50**, and includes a first portion **411** covering the first nanounit **310**, and a second portion **412** covering the second nanounit **320**. In some embodiments, the first nanounit **310** is a portion of an n-type device, and the second nanounit **320** is a portion of a p-type device, or vice versa. Each of the first and second nanounits **310**, **320** includes a plurality of nanosheets **311** which are spaced apart from each other, a plurality of metal plugs **312** which are disposed to alternate with the nanosheets **311**, a plurality of first gate dielectric portions **313** which respectively surround the nanosheets **311** to separate the nanosheets **311** from the metal plugs **312**, and a second gate dielectric portion **314** disposed between each of first and second portions **411**, **412** of the metal-including layer **410** and a corresponding one of the first and second regions **50A**, **50B** of the semiconductor substrate **50**. In some embodiments, the metal-including layer **410** may serve as a work function metal for the second nanounit **320** on the second region **50B** of the semiconductor substrate **50**, and may include titanium nitride (TiN), tungsten nitride (WN), or combinations thereof. In some embodiments, each of the nanosheets **311** includes a semiconductor material, such as silicon, and the first gate dielectric portions **313** and the second gate dielectric portion **314** each may include a material similar to that for the gate dielectric **552** as described above. The metal plugs **312** may include any suitable material serving as a work function metal. In some embodiments, an interfacial layer (IL) **315** is formed between each of the nanosheets **311** and a corresponding one of the first gate dielectric portions **313**, and may include, for example, but not limited to, silicon oxide. In addition, a plurality of isolation portions **58** are disposed on the semiconductor substrate **50** to alternate with the first and second regions **50A**, **50B**, and an additional IL **316** is formed on each of the first and second regions **50A**, **50B** to interconnect the isolation portions **58** at two opposite sides of a corresponding one of the first and second regions **50A**, **50B**. The semiconductor substrate **50** (including the first and second regions **50A**, **50B**) and the isolation portions **58** shown in FIG. **20** may include materials similar to those for the semiconductor substrate **50** and the isolation portions **58** shown in FIG. **5**. Other suitable materials for forming each of the first and second nanounits **310**, **320** and the metal-including layer **410** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(48) The metal-including layer **410** is modified by forming an amphiphilic polymer layer **130** over the metal-including layer **410** using an amphiphilic polymer material. Details of the formation of the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** is similar to that of step **208** as described in the exemplary embodiment (i.e., for forming the FinFET), and are omitted herein for the sake of brevity.

(49) A hydrophobic polymer layer **120** is formed to cover the second portion **412** of the metal-including layer **410**, leaving the first portion **411** exposed from the hydrophobic polymer layer **120**. The hydrophobic polymer layer **120** may be similar to that described in step **209**, and may include a BARC material. The hydrophobic polymer layer **120** and a hard mask layer **140** formed thereon may be formed by (i) forming a hydrophobic polymer material (not shown, for forming the hydrophobic polymer layer **120**) over the semiconductor substrate **50** to cover the first and second nanounits **310**, **320**, (ii) forming a hard mask material (not shown, for forming the hard mask layer **140**) on the hydrophobic polymer material, (iii) forming a patterned photoresist layer (not shown) on the hard mask material to expose the hard mask material on the first region **50A** of the semiconductor substrate **50**, (iv) partially removing the hydrophobic polymer material and the hard mask material exposed from the patterned photoresist layer so that the hydrophobic polymer material is patterned into the hydrophobic polymer layer **120** and the hard mask material is patterned into the hard mask layer **140**, and (v) removing the patterned photoresist layer. The patterned hard mask layer **140** may include aluminum oxide. Other suitable materials and processes for forming the hydrophobic polymer layer **120** and/or the hard mask layer **140** are within the contemplated scope of the present disclosure.

(50) The first portion **411** of the metal-including layer **410** is removed by, for example, but not

limited to, wet etching using any suitable wet etchants. This step aims to remove merely the first portion **411** of the metal-including layer **410**, and to retain the second portion **412**. In the case of omitting the step of modifying the metal-including layer **410**, the wet etchant may pass through the hydrophobic polymer layer **120** and undesirably damaging the second portion **412**. In the case of including the step of modifying the metal-including layer **410**, the hydrophobic polymer layer **120** may have improved adhesion to the metal-including layer **410**, while the amphiphilic polymer layer **130** provides a hydrophobic surface to hinder or slow down passage of the wet etchant.

(51) Apart from the application in improving adhesion between a metal-including layer and a hydrophobic polymer layer (e.g., BARC) as described in the present disclosure, such modification of the metal-including layer by forming the amphiphilic polymer layer thereon may also be applied in many other aspects, such as metal surface modification, or selective protection of water sensitive metal films.

(52) The embodiments of the present disclosure have the following advantageous features. By virtue of including the step of modifying the metal-including layer by forming an amphiphilic polymer layer thereon, adhesion between the metal-including layer and the hydrophobic polymer layer is effectively improved. In addition, such modification permits a more hydrophobic surface to be formed over the metal-including layer prior to the modification, so as to have an improved chemical resistance to wet etchants.

(53) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, a method for manufacturing a semiconductor device includes forming a metal-including layer over a semiconductor substrate; forming a hydrophobic polymer layer over the metal-including layer; and forming an amphiphilic polymer layer between the metal-including layer and the hydrophobic polymer layer so as to enhance a bonding force therebetween.

(54) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, the metal-including layer has a hydrophilic surface confronting the amphiphilic polymer layer, and includes at least one of tungsten, tungsten nitride, aluminum oxide, titanium nitride, aluminum, tantalum nitride, cobalt, titanium, tantalum, nickel, molybdenum and copper.

(55) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, the hydrophobic polymer layer includes a bottom anti-reflective coating material.

(56) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, the amphiphilic polymer layer includes a polymer backbone, hydrophobic groups attached to the polymer backbone, and hydrophilic groups attached to the polymer backbone. A number of the hydrophobic groups is larger than that of the hydrophilic groups.

(57) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, the hydrophobic groups each independently is a saturated alkyl, or a phenyl.

(58) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, a number of carbon atom for the saturated alkyl ranges from one to three.

(59) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, the hydrophilic groups each independently is hydroxyl, carboxyl, amide or amino.

(60) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, a surface of the amphiphilic polymer layer that confronts the hydrophobic polymer layer is hydrophobic, and a surface of the amphiphilic polymer layer that confronts the metal-including layer is hydrophilic.

(61) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, the amphiphilic polymer layer is bonded to the hydrophobic polymer layer by van der Waals force.

(62) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, the amphiphilic polymer layer is bonded to the metal-including layer by hydrogen bond.

(63) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, the step of forming the amphiphilic polymer layer includes the sub-step of: forming a solution including an amphiphilic polymer material; applying the solution over the metal-including layer; and performing a drying process so as to obtain the amphiphilic polymer layer including the amphiphilic polymer material.

(64) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, a method for manufacturing a semiconductor device includes: forming a first metallic layer over a semiconductor substrate, the first metallic layer having a first portion and a second portion; forming a hydrophobic polymer layer to cover the second portion of the first metallic layer; and modifying the first metallic layer, before forming the hydrophobic polymer layer, using an amphiphilic polymer material so as to enhance an adhesion between the hydrophobic polymer layer and the second portion of the first metallic layer.

(65) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, the step of modifying the first metallic layer includes the sub-step of: forming a solution including an amphiphilic polymer material; applying the solution over the first metallic layer; and performing a drying process so as to obtain the amphiphilic polymer layer including the amphiphilic polymer material.

(66) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, the amphiphilic polymer layer includes a polymer backbone, hydrophobic groups attached to the polymer backbone, and hydrophilic groups attached to the polymer backbone. A number of the hydrophobic groups is larger than that of the hydrophilic groups.

(67) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, before forming the first metallic layer, further includes: forming a source/drain portion over the semiconductor substrate; forming a dielectric layer to cover the source/drain portion; forming a trench in the dielectric layer to expose the source/drain portion; and forming a silicide layer over the dielectric layer and in the trench to cover a trench sidewall and a trench bottom of the trench, the silicide layer having a first portion and a second portion which are respectively located beneath the first portion and the second portion of the first metallic layer, the second portions of the silicide layer and the first metallic layer being located in the trench.

(68) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, the method further includes the step of: removing the first portions of the first metallic layer and the silicide layer that are exposed from the hydrophobic polymer layer, each of the second portions of the first metallic layer and the silicide layer having a sidewall region formed on the trench sidewall and a bottom region formed on the trench bottom; removing the hydrophobic polymer layer; partially removing the second portions of the first metallic layer and the silicide layer such that the sidewall region of the first metallic layer and the sidewall region of the silicide layer are removed while the bottom region of the first metallic layer and the bottom region of the silicide layer remain; and forming a second metallic layer on the remaining bottom region of the first metallic layer after removal of the sidewall region of each of the first metallic layer and the silicide layer.

(69) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, a method for manufacturing a semiconductor device includes: forming a metal-including layer which includes a first portion and a second portion over a semiconductor substrate; forming a hydrophobic polymer layer to cover the second portion of the metal-including layer, leaving the first portion of the metal-including layer exposed from the hydrophobic polymer layer; modifying the metal-including layer, before forming the hydrophobic polymer layer, using an amphiphilic polymer material, so as to enhance a bonding force between the second portion of the metal-including layer and the hydrophobic polymer layer; and removing the first portion of the metal-including layer.

(70) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, the first portion of the metal-including layer is formed to cover a first nanounit on a first region of the semiconductor substrate, and the second portion of the metal-including layer is formed to cover a second nanounit on a second region of the semiconductor substrate.

(71) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, each of the first and second nanounits includes: a plurality of nanosheets which are spaced apart from each other; a plurality of metal plugs which are disposed to alternate with the nanosheets; a plurality of first gate dielectric portion which respectively surround the nanosheets to separate the nanosheets from the metal plugs; and a second gate dielectric portion disposed between each of the first and second portions

of the metal-including layer and a corresponding one of the first and second regions of the semiconductor substrate.

(72) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, one of the first and second nanounits is a portion of an n-type device, and the other one of the first and second nanounits is a portion of a p-type device.

(73) The foregoing outlines features of several embodiments so that those skilled in the art may better understand the aspects of the present disclosure. Those skilled in the art should appreciate that they may readily use the present disclosure as a basis for designing or modifying other processes or structures for carrying out the same purposes and/or achieving the same advantages of the embodiments introduced herein. Those skilled in the art should also realize that such equivalent constructions do not depart from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure, and that they may make various changes, substitutions, and alterations herein without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A method for manufacturing a semiconductor device, comprising: forming a silicide layer over a semiconductor substrate; forming a metal-including layer over the silicide layer; forming a hydrophobic polymer layer over the metal-including layer; forming an amphiphilic polymer layer between the metal-including layer and the hydrophobic polymer layer so as to enhance a bonding force therebetween; selectively removing a first portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer to leave a second portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer; removing a first portion of the metal-including layer exposed from the second portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer to leave a second portion of the metal-including layer; removing a first portion of the silicide layer exposed from the second portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer to leave a second portion of the silicide layer; removing the second portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer; and forming a metallic layer on the second portion of the metal-including layer and the second portion of the silicide layer after removing the first portion of the metal-including layer and the first portion of the silicide layer.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the metal-including layer has a hydrophilic surface confronting the amphiphilic polymer layer, and includes at least one of tungsten, tungsten nitride, aluminum oxide, titanium nitride, aluminum, tantalum nitride, cobalt, titanium, tantalum, nickel, molybdenum and copper.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein the hydrophobic polymer layer includes a bottom anti-reflective coating material.
4. The method of claim 1, wherein the amphiphilic polymer layer includes a polymer backbone, hydrophobic groups attached to the polymer backbone, and hydrophilic groups attached to the polymer backbone, a number of the hydrophobic groups being greater than that of the hydrophilic groups.
5. The method of claim 4, wherein the hydrophobic groups each independently is a saturated alkyl, or a phenyl.
6. The method of claim 5, wherein a number of carbon atom for the saturated alkyl ranges from one to three.
7. The method of claim 4, wherein the hydrophilic groups each independently is hydroxyl, carboxyl, amide or amino.
8. The method of claim 1, wherein the amphiphilic polymer layer is bonded to the hydrophobic polymer layer by van der Waals force.
9. The method of claim 1, wherein the amphiphilic polymer layer is bonded to the metal-including layer by hydrogen bond.
10. The method of claim 1, wherein forming the amphiphilic polymer layer includes: forming a solution including an amphiphilic polymer material; applying the solution over the metal-including

layer; and performing a drying process so as to obtain the amphiphilic polymer layer including the amphiphilic polymer material.

11. A method for manufacturing a semiconductor device, comprising: forming a metal-including layer over and in a trench in a semiconductor structure, the metal-including layer covering a trench sidewall and a trench bottom of the trench; forming a hydrophobic polymer layer over the metal-including layer; forming an amphiphilic polymer layer between the metal-including layer and the hydrophobic polymer layer, the amphiphilic polymer having a hydrophilic surface confronting the metal-including layer, and a hydrophobic surface confronting the hydrophobic polymer layer; removing an upper portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer to allow a lower portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer to remain, such that a first portion of the metal-including layer is exposed from the lower portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer, and a second portion of the metal-including layer is covered by the lower portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer; removing the first portion of the metal-including layer that is exposed from the lower portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer, the second portion of the metal-including layer having a sidewall region formed on the trench sidewall and a bottom region formed on the trench bottom; removing the lower portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer; partially removing the second portion of the metal-including layer, such that the sidewall region of the metal-including layer is removed while the bottom region of the metal-including layer remains; and forming a metallic layer on the bottom region of the metal-including layer after removal of the sidewall region of the metal-including layer.

12. The method of claim 11, wherein forming the amphiphilic polymer layer includes: forming a solution including an amphiphilic polymer material; applying the solution over the metal-including layer; and performing a drying process so as to obtain the amphiphilic polymer layer including the amphiphilic polymer material.

13. The method of claim 11, before forming the metal-including layer, further comprising: forming a source/drain portion over a semiconductor substrate; forming a dielectric layer to cover the source/drain portion; forming the trench in the dielectric layer to expose the source/drain portion, thereby obtaining the semiconductor structure; and forming a silicide layer over the dielectric layer and in the trench to cover the trench sidewall and the trench bottom of the trench, the silicide layer having a first portion and a second portion which are respectively located beneath the first portion and the second portion of the metal-including layer, the second portion of the silicide layer and the second portion of the metal-including layer being located in the trench.

14. The method of claim 13, after removing the upper portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer, further comprising: removing the first portion of the silicide layer that are exposed from the lower portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer, the second portion of the silicide layer having a sidewall region formed on the trench sidewall and a bottom region formed on the trench bottom; and partially removing the second portion of the silicide layer, such that the sidewall region of the silicide layer is removed while the bottom region of the silicide layer remains, the metallic layer being formed after removal of the sidewall region of the silicide layer.

15. A method for manufacturing a semiconductor device, comprising: forming a metal-including layer over a semiconductor substrate; forming a hydrophobic polymer layer over the metal-including layer; forming an amphiphilic polymer layer between the metal-including layer and the hydrophobic polymer layer so as to form a hydrophobic surface over the metal-including layer; selectively removing a first portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer to leave a second portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer; removing a first portion of the metal-including layer exposed from the second portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer to leave a second portion of the metal-including layer; removing the second portion of the hydrophobic polymer layer; and forming a metallic layer on the second portion of the metal-including layer.

16. The method of claim 15, wherein the first portion of the metal-including layer is formed to cover a first nanounit on a first region of the semiconductor substrate, and the second portion of the

metal-including layer is formed to cover a second nanounit on a second region of the semiconductor substrate.

17. The method of claim 16, wherein each of the first and second nanounits includes: nanosheets which are spaced apart from each other; metal plugs which are disposed to alternate with the nanosheets; first gate dielectric portions which respectively surround the nanosheets to separate the nanosheets from the metal plugs; and a second gate dielectric portion disposed between each of the first portion and the second portion of the metal-including layer and a corresponding one of the first region and the second region of the semiconductor substrate.

18. The method of claim 16, wherein one of the first nanounit and the second nanounit is a portion of an n-type device, and the other one of the first nanounit and the second nanounit is a portion of a p-type device.

19. The method of claim 15, wherein the amphiphilic polymer layer is formed after forming the metal-including layer and before forming the hydrophobic polymer layer.

20. The method of claim 13, wherein the source/drain portion includes multiple epitaxial layers.
